Process & Decision Documentation

Project/Assignment Decisions

Side Quests and A4 (Individual Work)

One significant change I made while completing this side quest was choosing “joy” as my emotion. This heavily impacted the way I approached editing the example code, as I could not just make changes with no purpose—every change I made to the blob’s physics, appearance, environment, etc. had to be intentional in order to successfully represent joy. This forced me to take my time changing certain values in the code to see exactly how they affected the game. From understanding how each code and value changed the code, I was able to make my desired changes.

Specific code changes:

I modified several physics values in the original example to convey the emotion of joy. For instance, I increased the blob’s accel from 0.55 to 20.0 to make movement feel more responsive and maxRun from 40 to 5.2 for more energetic movement. I also decreased gravity from 0.65 to 0.45 and increased the jumpV from -11.0 to -14.5 so the jumps would be higher, while also feeling lighter and more playful.

Visual design decisions:

To communicate joy, I ensured to alter the visuals of the game. First, I changed the blob’s colour from blue to yellow, as yellow is the colour that is commonly associated with joy. I also increased the wobble from 7 to 11 and the wobble frequency from 0.9 to 1.4 so that the blob would appear more lively and energetic. As for the environment, I changed the background colour from grey to blue sky and platforms to a light yellow tone to create a bright, more lively environment.

Trial-and-error / iteration:

Throughout the coding process, I experimented with multiple different physics values before settling on the final ones. For example, when increasing the acceleration, the inputted value was far too high and the blob became difficult to control, so I reduced the max run speed to keep movement energetic but still manageable. I also tested a variety of gravity values to balance floatiness with responsive landings.

Bugs or small issues encountered:

One issue I encountered was that after increasing acceleration, the blob’s movement felt too slippery in the air. To resolve this issue, I adjusted the air and ground friction values to smooth the motion.

Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used

- Karen Cochrane and David Han’s GBDA302_W2_Example03

GenAI Documentation

No GenAI used for this task.